

she led the WTA Tour with 55%, but in her 6-1, 6-1 debacle against Coco Gauff in Madrid, it was only 40%. Even worse, during her 6-1, 7-5 Italian Open third-round loss to Danielle Collins, Swiatek won just 22% of her second serve points. Power players attack her second serve with increasing success and dictate rallies thereafter. She has also produced more double faults (91) than aces (83) this season.

"I think the biggest thing is between her ears. At that level, I really think the mental aspects lead the physical most of the time," said Paul Annacone, who coached superstar Pete Sampras, on the *Inside-In Tennis Podcast*. "She seems a bit on edge. She is a type A personality, where she is a little intense all the time, which looks great when you are winning... but if you are a little negative... it is tough to calm yourself down and get back into a cool, composed, confident process."

Swiatek will eventually recover from this slump — but it won't happen at Roland Garros. I believe the Queen of Clay will alas be dethroned there.

No. 7 Mirra Andreieva

Mirror, mirror on the wall, is Mirra the greatest of them all? She may well be before the decade is over, but the 18-year-old Russian (**above, right**) still has a thing or two to learn to beat the elite at Roland Garros.

Although she says her favourite surface is clay, her best results this year have come on hard courts. The clever tactician, with a serve topping 120 mph, conquered Dubai with wins over Swiatek and Elena Rybakina, and then grabbed her biggest title at Indian Wells, after defeating Sabalenka, Swiatek, Elina Svitolina, and Rybakina.

"She has no weaknesses and has really good technique," raved all-time great Martina Navratilova. "She loves competing. She's not scared. I love it. She's like a sponge. She takes everything in. She brings notes to the court." Coached by canny Conchita Martinez, the delightfully witty prodigy should make the semifinals.



No. 18 Jelena Ostapenko

The Latvian slugger (**right**) shocked everyone by winning Roland Garros eight years ago as a 100-1 long shot, becoming the first unseeded woman to capture a Major since 1933. She has more than a puncher's chance again — particularly if she faces Swiatek in the semis or the final.

She has Swiatek's number as perhaps no other non-star has ever had a champion's before: she has knocked her off all six times they've played, most recently on clay in the Stuttgart quarterfinals, 6-3, 3-6, 6-2.

On a given day, the go-for-broke Ostapenko can not only beat but crush anyone, as she proved by overpowering Sabalenka 6-4, 6-1 in the final. It was no fluke. At Doha in February, she knocked off Swiatek, three-time Major finalist Ons Jabeur,



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